

Game Review: The World Of Ragnarok Online

Based upon an eponymous Korean comic, Ragnarok Online (RO) is set in the mythical Viking kingdom of Rune-Midgard, where a long-kept peace between the gods, humans, and demons has been broken for reasons best known to themselves. The lands are now in turmoil, and the people are crying out for help. This is where you come in. Starting off as just another babe-in-the-woods, your aim is to rise among the ranks, growing in power until you're feared by your opponents and respected by allies. From this point on, you can begin taking an active part in the politics of the land, forging alliances and bringing your clan to a position of power.

The game allows you to choose your profession as a Swordsman, Mage, Archer, Thief, Merchant or Acolyte. Each character class has its innate strengths and weaknesses, so choose one that befits your playing style.

Irrespective of your choice however, you would do well to remember that you won't get too far into the game unless you team up with other players, preferably from other classes. The key to successful adventuring lies in creating a diverse and well co-ordinated team of players.

Key to the Ragnarok experience is the people you'll encounter in the game - people like yourself, looking for some adventure and a whole lot of fun. The strength of any MMOG (Massively Multiplayer Online Game) is the sense of community you get

while interacting with other players. After teaming up with a few other characters, you'll be able to take on very tough monsters without any hesitation. And the level-ups - well, they'll just keep on coming.

The game is a first-generation MMOG released nearly five years ago, and it has seen phenomenal success in all the countries it's been released in so far. Its mass appeal and usage is thanks to its low system requirements, with only a 400 MHz CPU required for playing the game. Despite its age, the

special effects used for spells manage to be spectacular. Rest assured, Ragnarok will use your PC to the fullest extent while displaying graphics you wouldn't have thought possible from an RPG such as this.

Unlike a shooting or racing game where you can just pick up the controls and play, Ragnarok requires you to learn a bit about the game first. However, if

you give it a little time, you'll find a great game that doesn't take itself too seriously. A huge user base of nearly 12 million across South-East Asia is testament to the popularity of the game. In fact, in a rather bizarre development some time back, the Thai government had laid a curfew on the number of hours Ragnarok's servers were allowed to run. This game will appeal to most gamers (and even people who've never played PC games seriously before). The word that really summarizes Ragnarok Online, at least in my opinion, would have to be addictive.



Adventuring is hard work. Time for a small rest and catching up on some gossip



Help is easily available - both from the in-game Kafa Staff and other players



Hunting monsters is much more fun when you do it with friends